



Consequences of Centripetal Forces

- Promoting cultural cohesion
- More equitable infrastructure development



Nationalism

- Nationalism
 - **Ethnic nationalism**
 - **Civic nationalism**



Nationalism is the identification with one's own nation and support for its interests. It is a strong binding force within a group.

With **ethno-nationalism**, the nation is created by a shared ethnic and/or cultural identity. Basically, people with common language, religion, customs, and cultural traditions are united through their commonalities and form a nation. That nation is the basis for the state, the political structure, and borders. This means that in ethnic nationalism, the government must identify with a single ethnic group and be seen as representative of the nation. We can also understand ethnic nationalism by what it's not. Since ethnic nationalism creates national identity through pre-existing characteristics like ethnicity, it's not based on any sense of equal political or social rights. Divisions by class and wealth can exist without being seen as immoral or unfair because the nation isn't defined by political unity, just ethnic unity.

However, nationalism can sometimes be a centrifugal force within a multi-national state, especially when one group supports its own interests to the exclusion or detriment of the interests of other nations within the state. Those who do not belong to the main ethno-nationalism group are considered outsiders, and new immigrants must fully assimilate if they are to "belong".

Civic nationalism, on the other hand, is a political identity built around shared citizenship within the state. Thus, a "civic nation" isn't defined by its language or culture, but by its political institutions and liberal principles, which its citizens pledge to uphold. Membership in the civic nation is open to anyone who shares these values. Popular representation is an important part of civic nationality – voters feel they have a voice in the decisions of the government if the voters, no matter their culture, language, or other “differences” from the majority of the population, have the chance to participate. In theory, a civic nation or state does not aim to promote one culture over another.

Promoting Cultural Cohesion

- Unifying institutions
 - Religious education
 - Secular education
 - Sociofacts (The Constitution)



Institutions are the ways in which a society passes on their collective knowledge and culture to the next generation (think back to the culture unit).

These institutions include schools – both religious and secular – and the sociofacts (those culture elements that include the norms and “rules”) of a society.

Examples in the United States – The Constitution, secular public schools (if a student receives a religious education or not is at the will of the parents, and freedom of religion means they can practice/learn any religion they choose or none at all). Another sociofact – saying the Pledge of Allegiance each morning, which promotes civic nationality, which is a centripetal force within a multi-ethnic country.

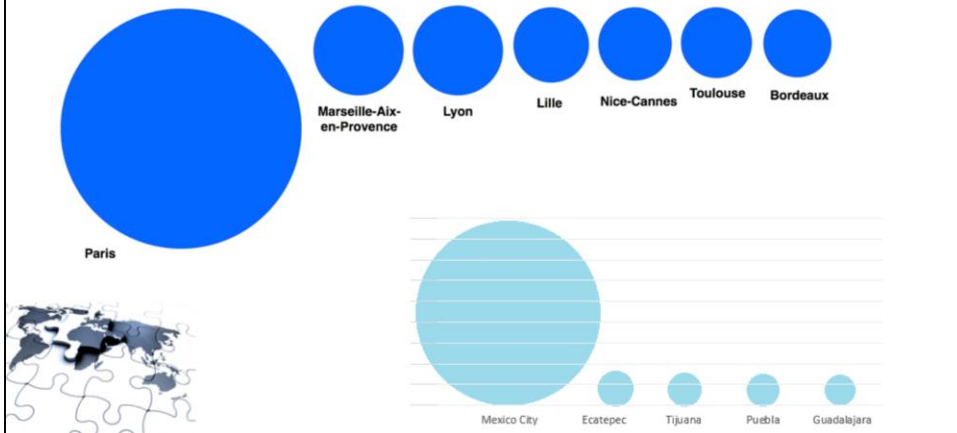
Strong Central Government



In the earliest days of the United States under the Articles of Confederation, there were grim economic situations and political crises in the 1780s that compelled the American people to make a right choice to set up a stronger central government. Although the United States won their independence from England in the Revolution, its war debts (including bonds purchased by the American people) could not be paid, the economy could not develop because there was no cohesiveness among the 13 states or an integrated infrastructure, the people's living standard could not be improved, and the country could not be defended against the British occupation of portions of North America nor from attacks on farmers by natives. The chaotic domestic situation and foreign threats impelled the founders of the new nation to take extreme measures – which included abolishing the Articles of Confederation and replacing them with the Constitution. Included in this reform: federal government structure with a stronger central government, allocation of powers and rights to the states, legal system, etc.. This reform saved the country and also set up a cultural system of civic nationality in the already multi-ethnic new country.

Equitable Infrastructure Development

- Strong “primate city” (smaller countries)
- Transportation, communication, economy



Small countries often have what is known as a “primate city” – a city whose population is disproportionately large compared to the next largest city. For example, in a country with a primate city, the largest city may have 10 million people, the next largest would have 1 million or fewer. In a state without a primate city, the 2nd largest city would be about ½ the size of the largest city (largest 10 million, next largest 5 million), the next largest would be 1/3 the size (about 3.3 million), etc. The larger a state is, the less likely it is to have a primate city due to territorial size and population distribution.

Primate cities do not just have a disproportionate population compared to other cities in the state – they also have a disproportionate share of the economy and political power. Primate cities in smaller states with a strong central government are a powerful centripetal force. The infrastructure of the state connects the people in the other parts of the country to the main city (usually the capital city), so the people feel connected to the government. The illustration above (top) shows the relative size of Paris compared to the next largest cities in France. Paris is a primate city. The illustration above (bottom) shows Mexico City’s relative size compared to the next largest cities within Mexico. Mexico City is a primate city – they exist in countries at all levels of economic development.

In large states, equal infrastructure development is much more difficult to achieve. The United States worked to improve infrastructure development throughout its history. You learned about the Eisenhower Interstate Highway System in the last set of notes. There have been other times infrastructure development has been a made a priority of the country, dating back to the founding of the country. One of the reasons the government was reformed under the Constitution was to give the central government a greater role (and responsibility) in building the country's infrastructure and regulating interstate trade to make it more equal across the states. If the people are connected to each other and to the government, it acts as more of a centripetal force. Uneven infrastructure development also played a role in the Civil War, and the Reconstruction period saw greater investment in infrastructure as the country was working to rebuild after the war. The Great Depression hit in the 1930s – Franklin D. Roosevelt ran for president with promises of infrastructure development projects to help pull the country out of the Depression. The “New Deal” period oversaw development that would help bring the country out of the depression and into peak industrialization – hydroelectric dams, highways, sidewalks, and other major construction projects helped put people back to work.

Consequences of Centrifugal forces

- Primate city (negatives)
- Uneven economic development
- Stateless nations



You've already learned a great deal about centripetal forces and the consequences (devolution and/or separatist movements) in previous sets of notes. This slide is a quick review.

Primate cities have a disproportionate share of people, economic might, and political power. This can cause issues within a state especially if there is unequal infrastructure development. Infrastructure serves to bind people together physically and economically, and communications infrastructure are vital for communication between the government and the citizens (see "Challenges of governance" notes for more detail). If areas within a state are cut off from this infrastructure, they may be economically disadvantaged and/or have a significantly lower standard of living, or be cut off from the political process. This uneven infrastructure and/or economic development combined with little ability to participate in the political process would be a centrifugal force. For example: Scotland – Scotland is less economically robust compared to the primate city of the UK, London. Scotland felt the legislature in London did little to meet their needs, including financial security of the region. Therefore, Scotland pushed for and won greater local control with the creation of the Scottish Legislature (devolution within the UK).

In other places, ethno-nationalism is a central issue as some groups have more political power than others and act in such a way that is a detriment to the other ethnic groups. This causes separatist movements based on ethnic nationality and contributes to the formation of stateless nations (when the nation wants to have their own state with their own government and their own territory and self-determination to handle their own political, economic, and social affairs).

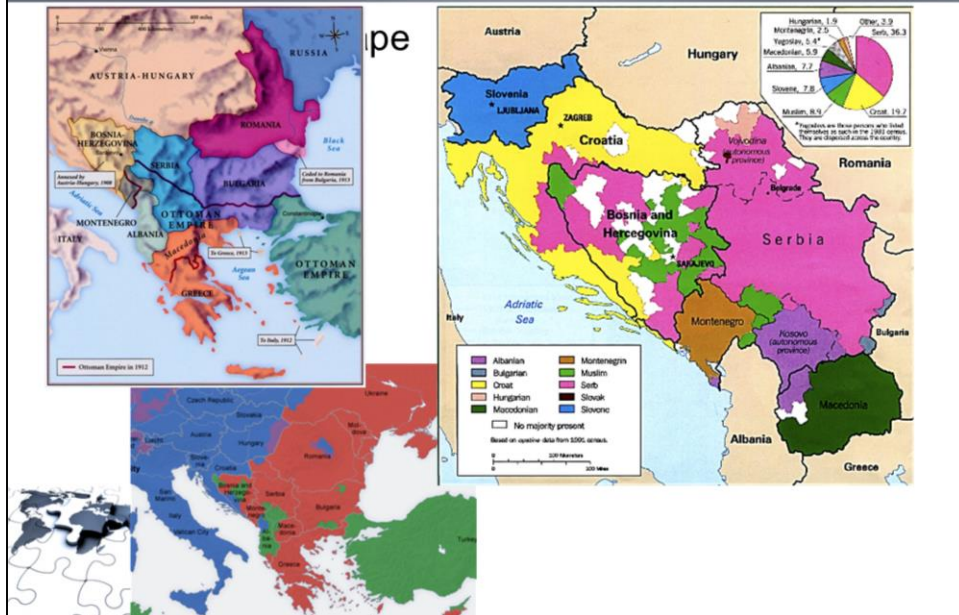
Both images above are from Mexico – the modern landscape of Mexico city compared to the slums of outlying areas.

Balkanization



Balkanization is a geopolitical term for the process of fragmentation or division of a region or state into smaller regions or states that are often hostile or uncooperative with one another (mutually-warring factions). It is named after the crisis in the Balkan Peninsula following World War I and the violent breakup of Yugoslavia.

Geographical Context



The physical geography of the Balkans peninsula is not particularly well-suited for the development of states – it has a rugged topography, there are no truly navigable rivers around which to build a nation-state (remember, rivers were vital for agriculture and trade not even 100 years ago due to limited technology). Groups on the peninsula became isolated from each other and developed separate ethnic identities.

The map on the top left shows the physical landscape of the Balkan Peninsula (mountainous), bottom left shows the area of influence resulting from occupation by the various empires over time (Roman Catholic, Orthodox Christian, and Islam). The map on the right shows the distribution of the different ethno-nationalist groups throughout the region.



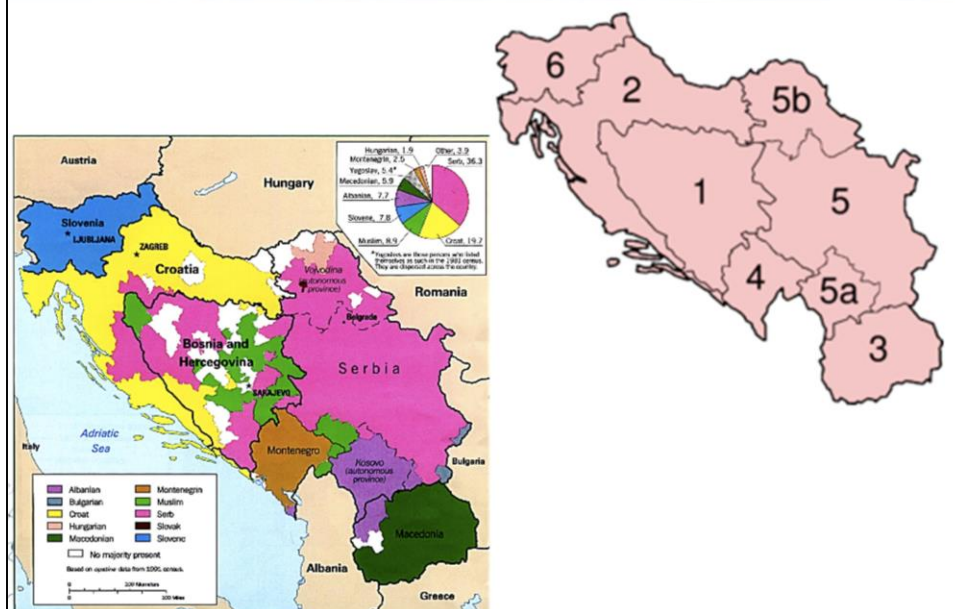
There were also overlapping empires that took control of the region, and today it is the crossroads of the Roman Catholic (Astro-Hungarian empire), Eastern Orthodox (Byzantine Empire), and Islamic (Ottoman Empire) faiths.

The region known as Kosovo has a long history of conflict. IN 1389, the Serb Army (the Serbs are Eastern Orthodox Christians) was defeated by the Ottomans, which began a period of Islamic rule in the region. The region of Kosovo is considered sacred to the Serbs today.

Eventually, the Astro-Hungarian Empire pushed into the region. In 1914, a Serbian national assassinated the Archduke Franz Ferdinand, leader of the Austro-Hungarian empire and his wife, sparking World War I.

Following World War I, the boundaries of the region were redrawn to create Yugoslavia, which grouped these rival ethno-nationalist groups together within the same state.

The Balkans in WWII – 1980s



In the build-up and during World War II, the Nazis overran and occupied the Balkans, then set up a “puppet” (satellite state) regime in Croatia.

Croatia began a campaign of ethnic cleansing against the Serbs.

Josip Broz Tito had been the head of the Yugoslav Communist Party and had organized an effective campaign against the Nazis.

He came to power in 1945 and ruled unopposed for 35 years.

Yugoslavia was a Communist country, but Tito did not answer to Moscow (USSR).

Following Tito’s death in 1980, a system of autonomous regional governments was set up with attempts to divide along ethnic lines—an impossibility – compare the two maps above to see the boundaries of the autonomous regions with the distribution of the ethnic groups, particularly in Bosnia and Herzegovina (region 1 on the map to the right)

This system worked for about 10 years until changes in Eastern Europe brought ideas of independence (late 1980s).

Rival Groups/Rival supporters



There are three main rival ethno-nationalist groups in the Balkans. Each one is supported by other historical rivals in the international community.

Serbs – Eastern Orthodox. Supported by Russia

The Croats – Roman Catholic. Supported by Germany and other Western Europeans

The Bosnians – Islamic. Supported by other Islamic states



In 1987, a Serb nationalist named Slobodan Miliesovic came to power and proposed a “Greater Serbia”.

Serbia (predominantly Serbs) and Croatia (predominately Croats) seceded from Yugoslavia in 1991.

Bosnia seceded from Yugoslavia in 1992. It was split between two entities: The Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, and the Republika Srpska.

The Bosnian War was an international armed conflict that took place in Bosnia and Herzegovina in 1992. War broke out between the rival groups. It was brutal, and often targeted civilians and many human rights violations were committed. The main belligerents (the opposing sides) were the forces of the Republic of Bosnia and Herzegovina and those of the self-proclaimed Bosnian Serb and Bosnian Croat entities within Bosnia and Herzegovina. The Bosnian Serb population wanted to be part of Serbia, and the Croats wanted to be part of Croatia. Bosnia wanted a more ethnically homogeneous population.

UN intervention in the Balkans

- Peacekeeping missions



The United Nations does not have compulsive power. They can only act as peacekeepers.

NATO intervention in the Balkans



NATO, formed by the Western Bloc countries following World War II to stop the spread of communism has re-structured its purpose following the end of the Cold War. Since then, NATO has been called upon to help restore people in areas of conflict around the world (remember, an attack on one or their allies is considered an attack on all).

NATO (including US troops) occupied Bosnia.

Kosovo – 1998-1999



The **Kosovo War** was an armed conflict in Kosovo that started in early 1998 and lasted until mid 1999. It was fought by the forces of the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (i.e. Serbia and Montenegro), which controlled Kosovo before the war, and the Kosovo Albanian rebel group known as the Kosovo Liberation Army (KLA), with air support from the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO, which ramped up involvement in early 1999) and ground support from the Albanian army.

Who:

Albanians – Mostly Islamic

Serbs – Eastern Orthodox Christian

Albania is adjacent to Serbia.

Kosovo is an area of Serbia that is predominantly Albanian.

The Serbians were accused of ethnic cleansing and genocide against the Albanians in Kosovo. NATO quickly responded with airstrikes against the Serbs.

The Aftermath of the Crisis in the Balkans



Slobodan Milosevic (Serbia, shown above left) was arrested and taken to the Hague to stand trial on charges of crimes against humanity, including genocide. He died in March of 2006 while on trial.

Rodovan Karadzic (a Bosnian Serb politician, shown above right on trial)—was charged with war crimes committed against Bosnian Muslims and also for acts During the siege of Sarajevo. In 2008, he was arrested in Belgrade, where he had been hiding disguised as a doctor of alternative medicine. He was extradited to the Netherlands, he is in the custody of the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia in the United Nations Detention Unit of Scheveningen (the formal name of the prison by the United Nations for those charged with committing war crimes). He was charged with 11 counts of war crimes, and is sometimes referred to by the Western media as the "Butcher of Bosnia". In 2016, he was found guilty of genocide and 10 of the 11 counts of war crimes of which he had been accused. He was sentenced to 40 years in prison.



Bosnia and Herzegovina and Croatia have been independent since the early 1990s.

The borders of Serbia have been pushed back in the days since the end of the war. In 2006, Montenegro became independent from Serbia.

Kosovo declared independence from Serbia in 1998. Since then, over 50 countries have “recognized” Kosovo as independent as established diplomatic relations with their government. However, Kosovo is not yet a member of the United Nations as Russia (permanent member of the UN Security Council with veto power) vetoed their admittance.

Macedonia managed to secede from the former Yugoslavia without bloodshed. However, Greece refused to recognize their independence until they changed their official name to “The Former Yugoslavian Republic of Macedonia” to distinguish itself from the Macedonian region of Greece.

The new nations established in the region are moving toward a period of peace today. Most of them are working toward membership in the European

Union, which required they be in a period of peace and not fighting with each other to join. Croatia is already a member, Montenegro and Serbia are in negotiations, and Albania and Macedonia have declared their interest in joining. Bosnia and Kosovo are potential future members.